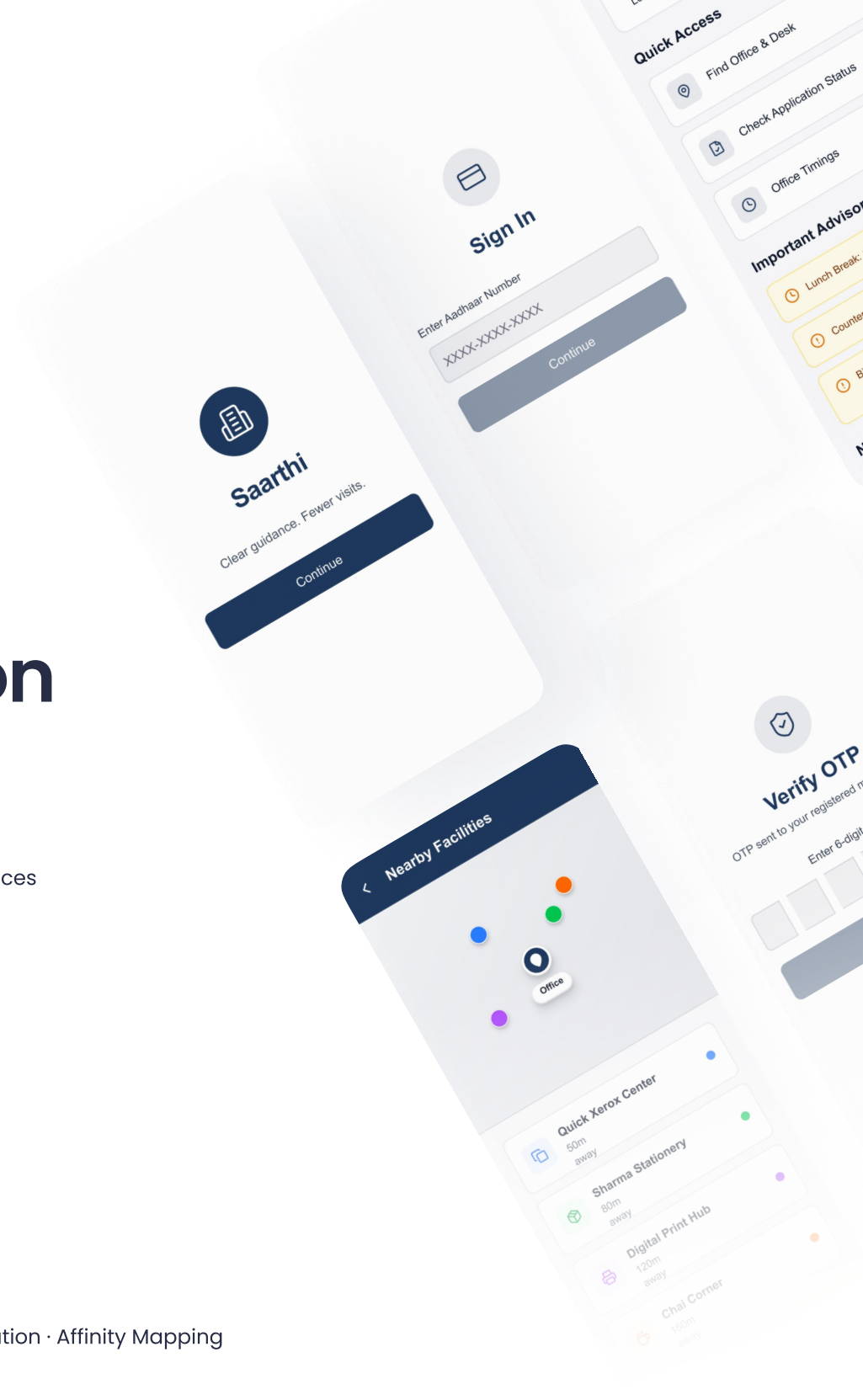
UX Research


Saarthi
Clear guidance. Fewer visits.
Continue
Sign In
Enter Aadhaar Number
XXXX-XXXX-XXXX
Continue
Quick Access
Find Office & Desk
Check Application Status
Office Timings
Important Advisor
Lunch Break
Nearby Facilities
Office
Quick Xerox Center
Sharma Stationery
Digital Print Hub
Chai Corner
Verify OTP
OTP sent to your registered m
Enter 6-digi

From Confusion to Clarity

Designing a Guidance System for Government Offices

Name: Gauri Joshi
Duration: 3 Weeks
Location: Gandhinagar Government Offices
Tools: Figma · Contextual Interviews · Field Observation · Affinity Mapping

Problem Statement

Citizens visiting government offices experience repeated visits, unclear navigation, and emotional stress due to lack of entry-level guidance, task-based information, and service transparency.

70%+
Users made repeat visits

10–15 visits
Users reported for one task

4/5 offices
No structured entry guidance observed

Objectives & Goals

- Understand why repeat visits are normalised
- Identify breakdown points in the service journey
- Reduce cognitive load during office visits
- Design a hybrid digital–physical guidance system
- Minimise dependency on agents

Our Process

Discover
Define
Ideate
Design

Challenges Faced

→ High operational load due to repeat visits
→ Increased staff friction
→ Informal agent economy
→ Reduced citizen trust
→ No unified digital–physical bridge

Product Users

Elderly rural/urban visitor, Working professionals and Students

Quantitative + Qualitative Research

To understand systemic friction in government offices, I conducted 8 field visits across 5 service centers in Gandhinagar, along with 17 contextual interviews. Observations were captured in real-time to identify behavioral patterns, navigation breakdowns, emotional responses, and repeat-visit triggers.

Observations

30%
Signage text-heavy & department-based

4 offices
No entry-level guidance

50%
Users rely on guards/agents

90%
Lunch-hour rush behavior

Emotional Indicators

Anxiety
“Will my work get done today?”

Helplessness
“I don't know who to ask anymore.”

Frustration
“They told me to come again.”

Uncertainty
“Am I at the right counter?”

Key Insights

→ Confusion is systemic
→ Repeat visits are normalized
→ Entry moments define experience
→ Digital exists but is unusable
→ Informal systems replace formal gaps

How Might We...

→ How might we reduce repeat visits?
→ How might we create task-based navigation?
→ How might we provide clarity before users arrive?
→ How might we reduce dependency on intermediaries?

Features & Functionalities

To resolve user needs

Saarthi is a task-based hybrid guidance system designed to provide clarity before, during, and after government office visits.

Pre-visit preparation
On-site navigation
Post-visit transparency

Before Visit
Document checklist
Eligibility criteria
Processing time
Appointment clarity

During Visit
Office, block, desk mapping
Nearby facilities
Real-time advisories

After Visit
Status tracking
Refusal explanation
Next eligible steps

Competitor Analysis

Criteria	Saarthi	UMANG	DigiLocker	mAadhaar
Task-based entry	✓	⚠	✗	✗
Document checklist	✓	✗	✗	✗
Office guidance	✓	✗	✗	✗
Entry-level guidance for first-time users	✓	✗	✗	✗
Focus on reducing repeat visits	✓	✗	✗	✗
Nearby facilities & contextual support	✓	✗	✗	✗

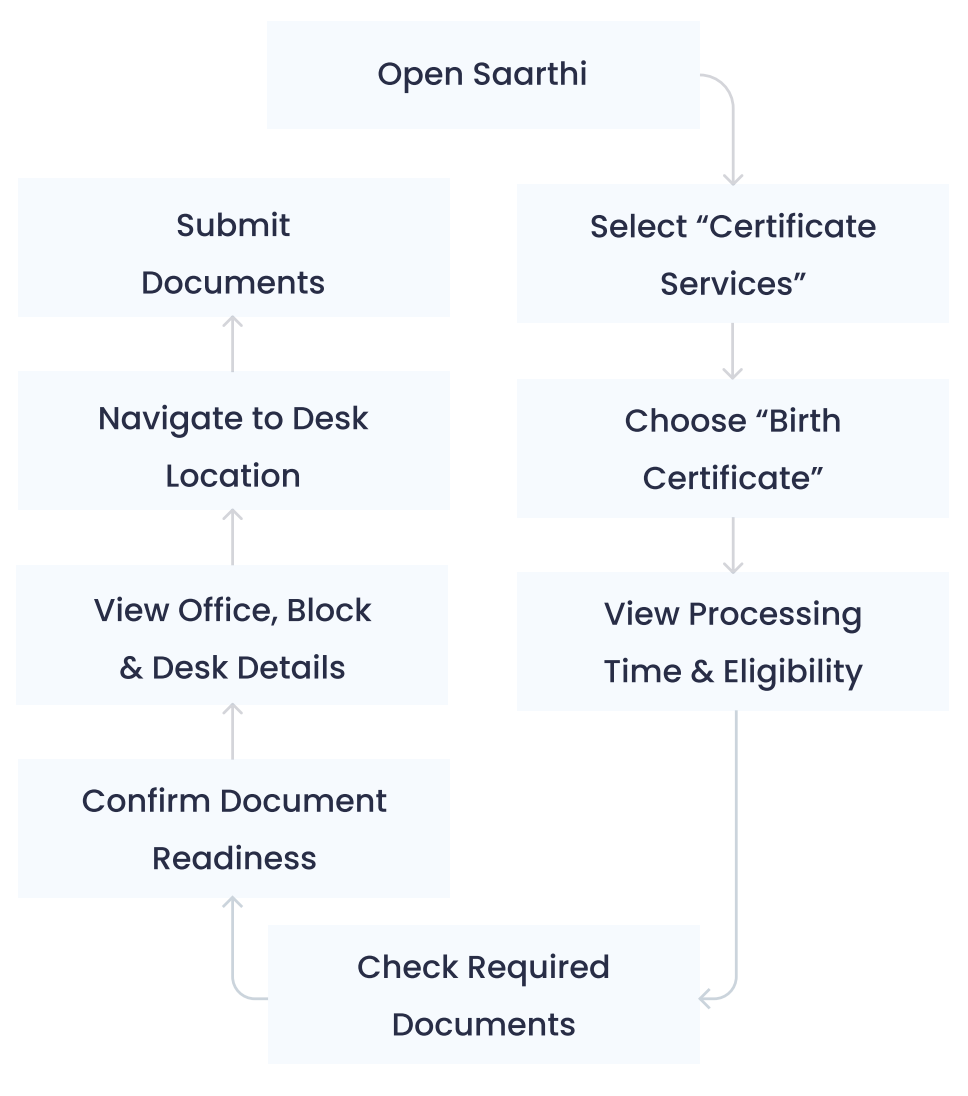
Unique Features

→ Task-Based Navigation: Users select what they want to do, not which department to visit.
→ Pre-Visit Document Readiness Check: Reduces rejected visits by confirming required documents beforehand.
→ Physical Desk & Block Mapping: Bridge between digital clarity and physical navigation.
→ Repeat-Visit Reduction Focus: Designed specifically to minimize follow-ups — unlike existing apps.
→ Contextual Nearby Facilities Mapping: Shows xerox, print shops, refreshment stalls, reducing on-ground friction.

Taskflows

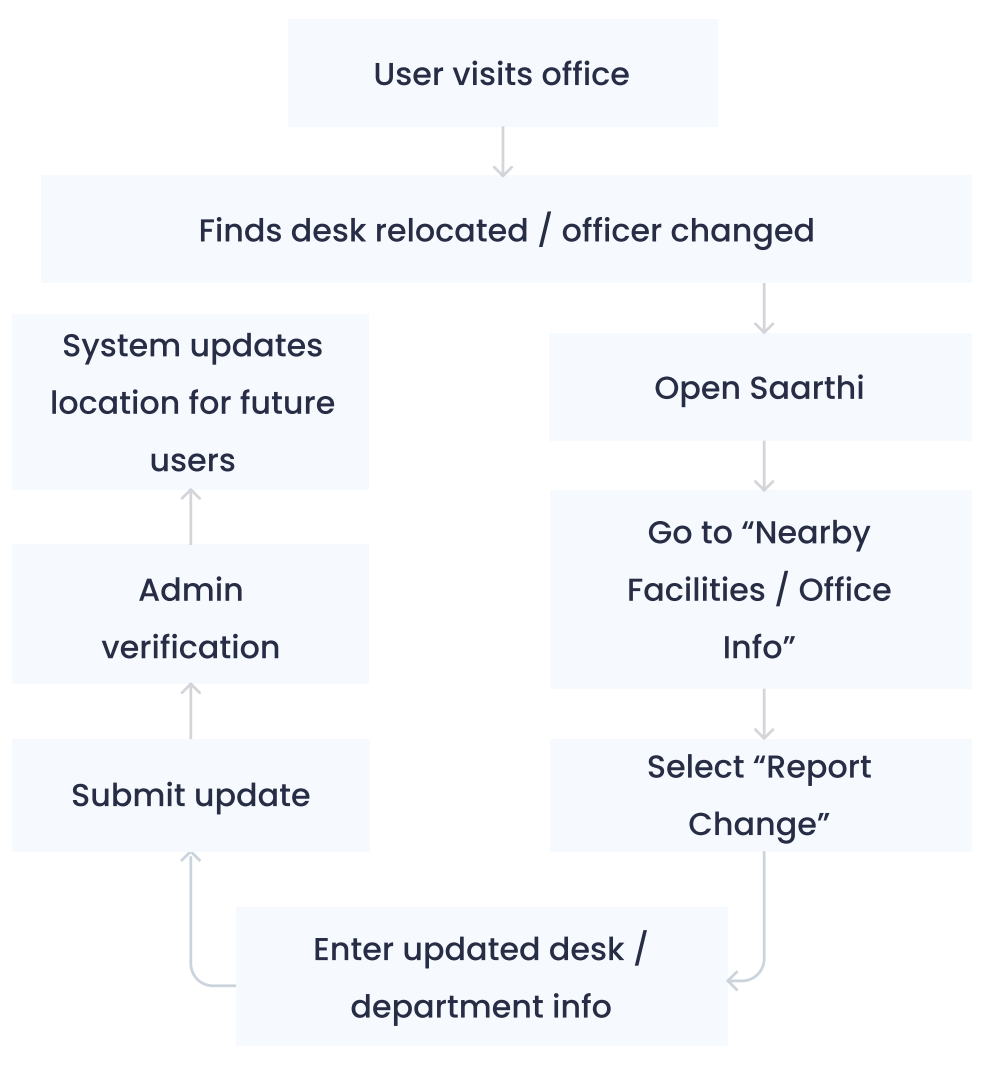
Scenario 1 :

User needs a Birth Certificate


Open Saarthi
Select “Certificate Services”
Choose “Birth Certificate”
View Processing Time & Eligibility
Check Required Documents
Confirm Document Readiness
View Office, Block & Desk Details
Navigate to Desk Location
Submit Documents

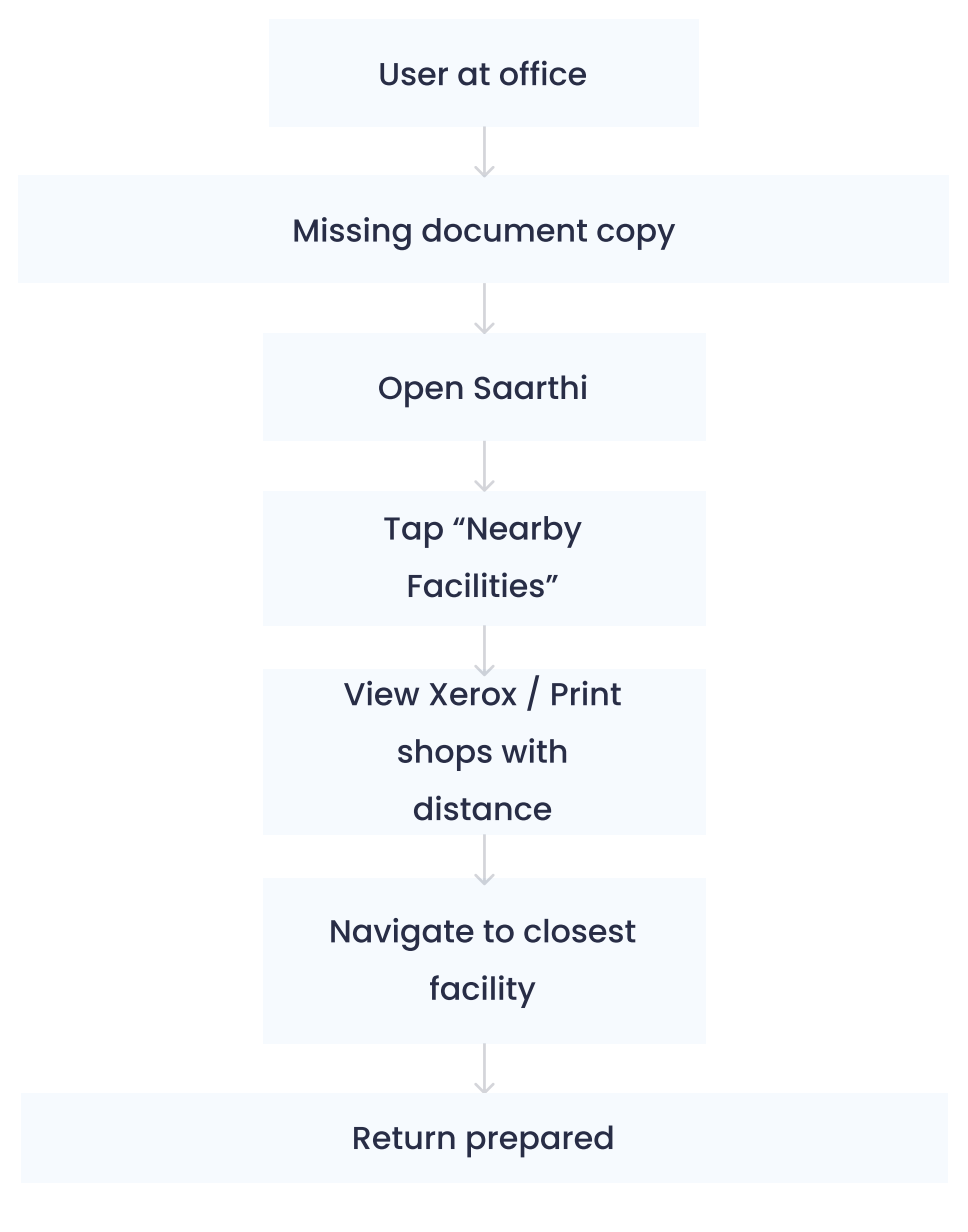
Scenario 2 :

User notices desk has shifted


User visits office
Finds desk relocated / officer changed
Open Saarthi
Go to “Nearby Facilities / Office Info”
Select “Report Change”
Enter updated desk / department info
Submit update
Admin verification
System updates location for future users

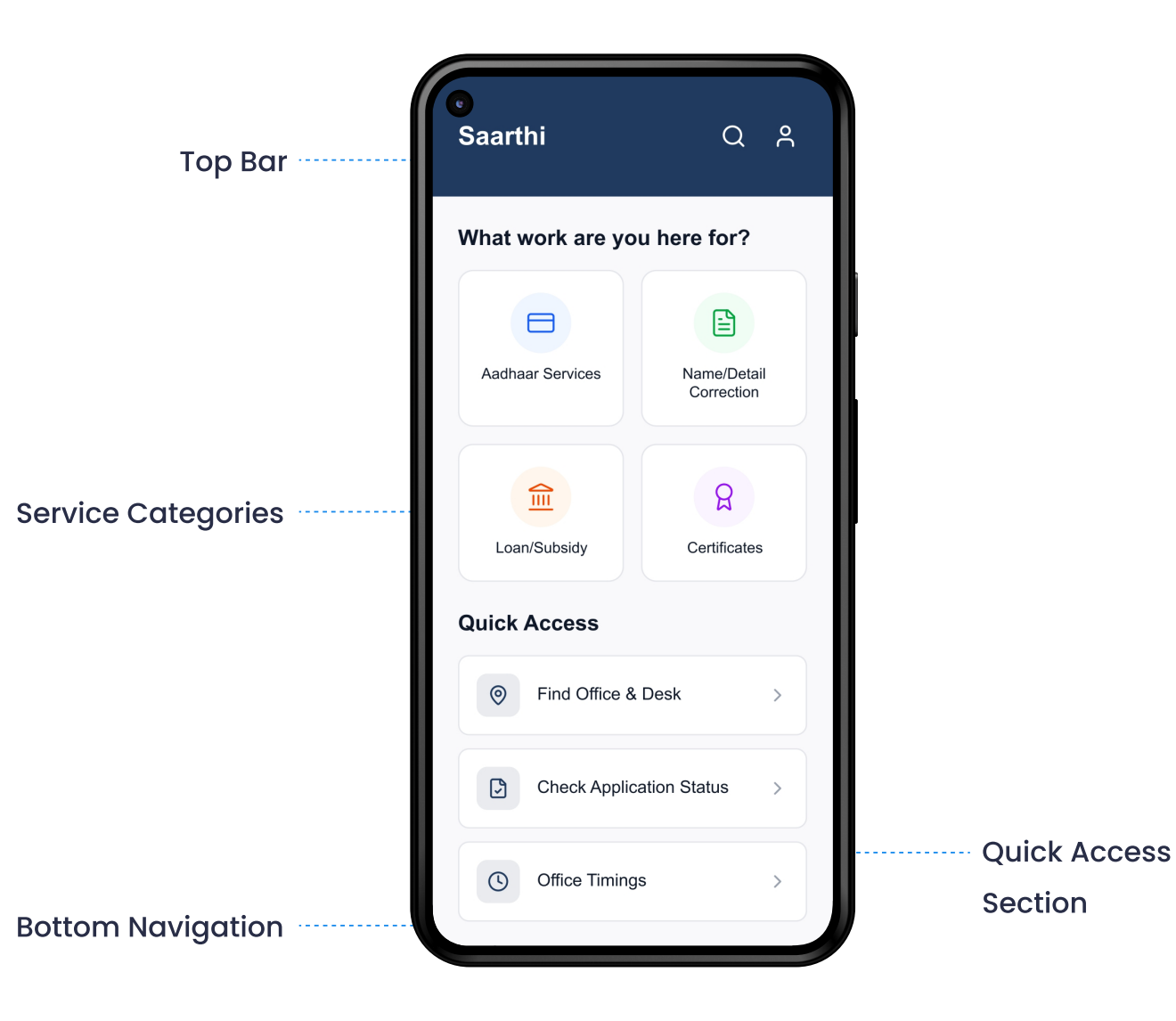
Scenario 3 :

User forgot xerox copies

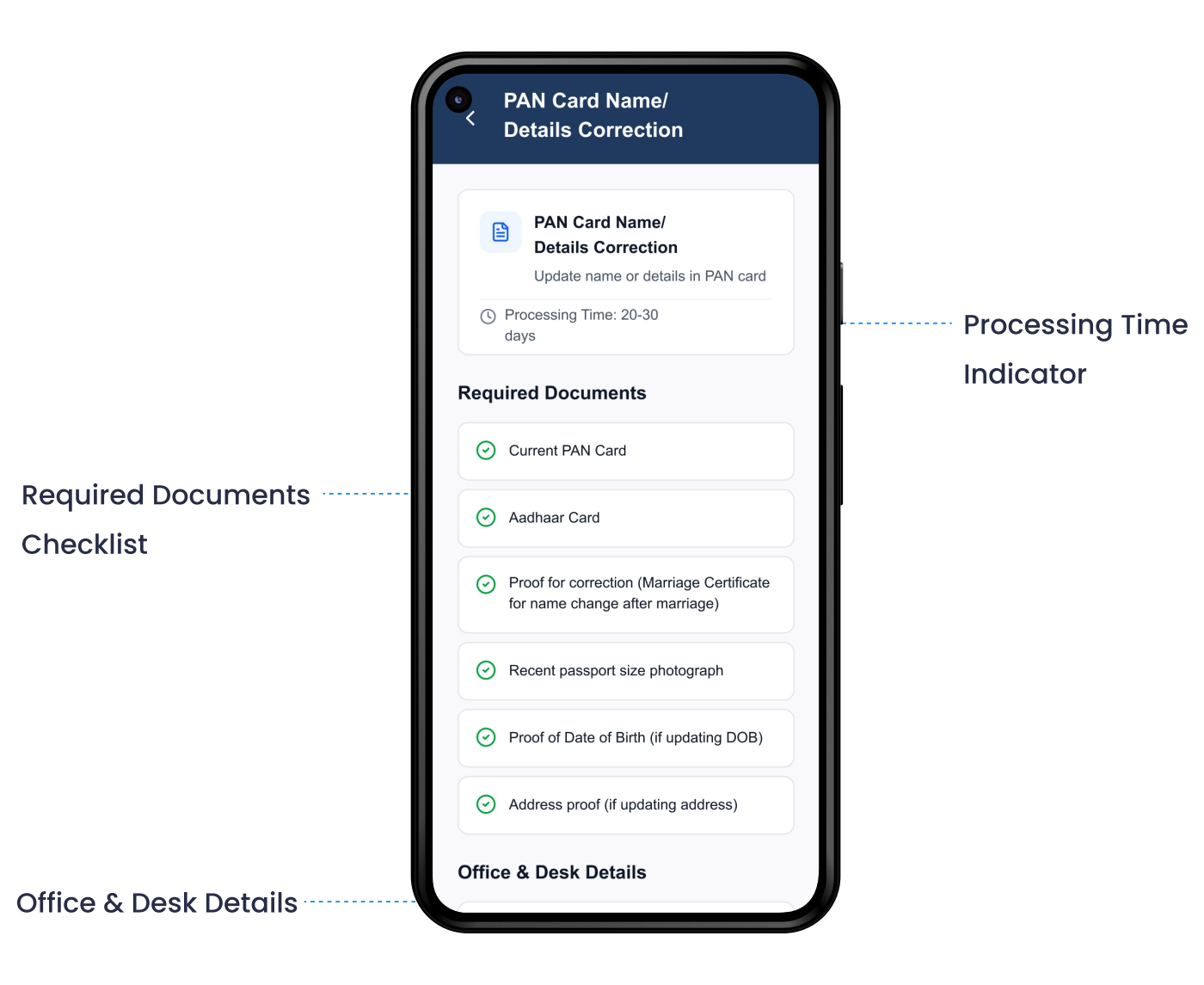

User at office
Missing document copy
Open Saarthi
Tap “Nearby Facilities”
View Xerox / Print shops with distance
Navigate to closest facility
Return prepared

Major Screens

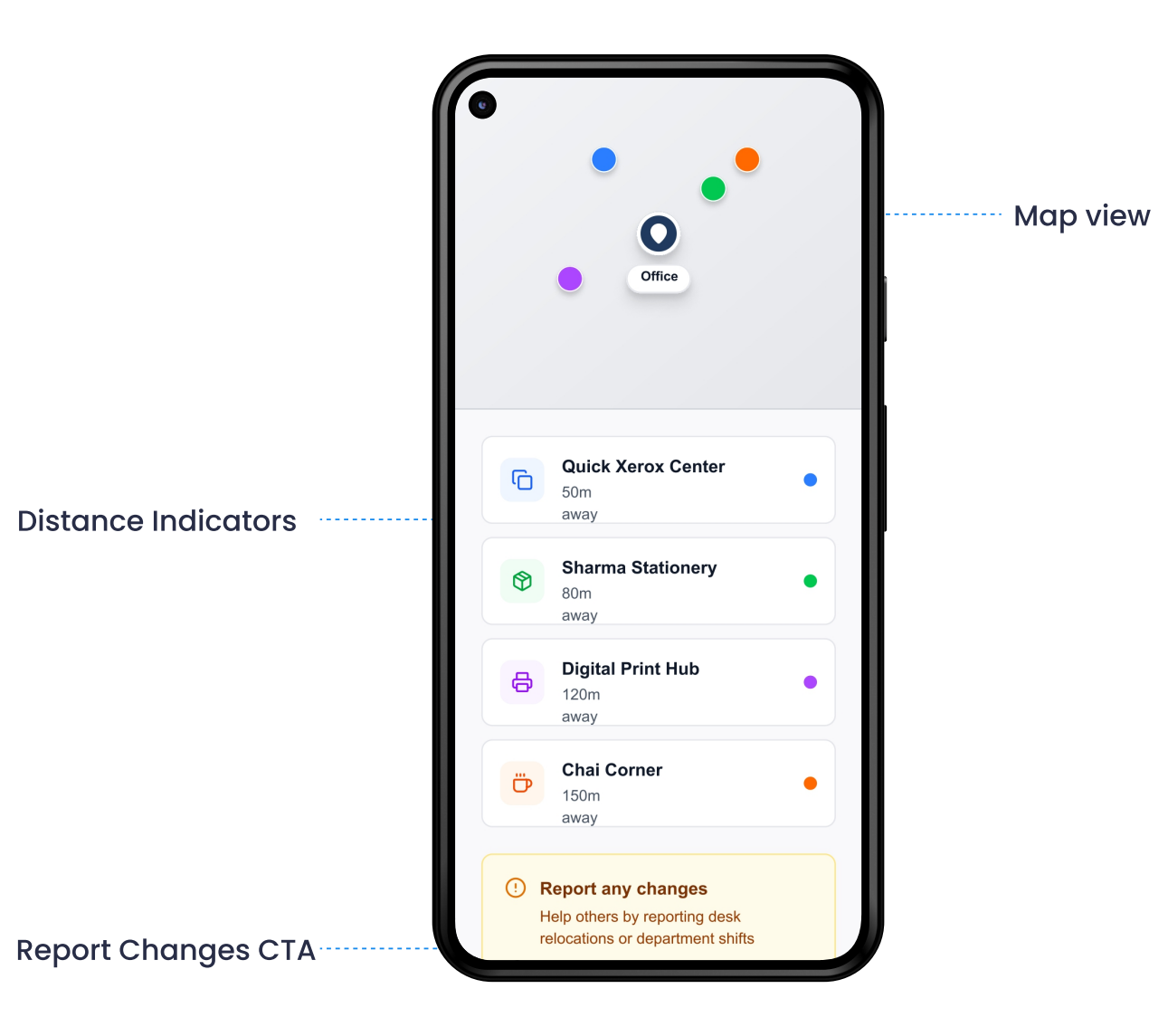
Home Dashboard


Top Bar
Service Categories
Bottom Navigation
Quick Access Section
Saarthi
What work are you here for?
Aadhaar Services
Name/Detail Correction
Loan/Subsidy
Certificates
Quick Access
Find Office & Desk
Check Application Status
Office Timings

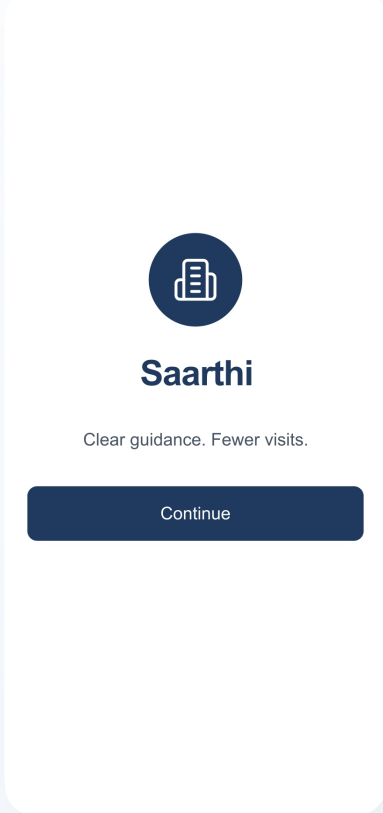
Service Detail Screen


Processing Time Indicator
Required Documents Checklist
Office & Desk Details
PAN Card Name/ Details Correction
PAN Card Name/ Details Correction
Update name or details in PAN card
Processing Time: 20-30 days
Required Documents
Current PAN Card
Aadhaar Card
Proof for correction (Marriage Certificate for name change after marriage)
Recent passport size photograph
Proof of Date of Birth (if updating DOB)
Address proof (if updating address)
Office & Desk Details

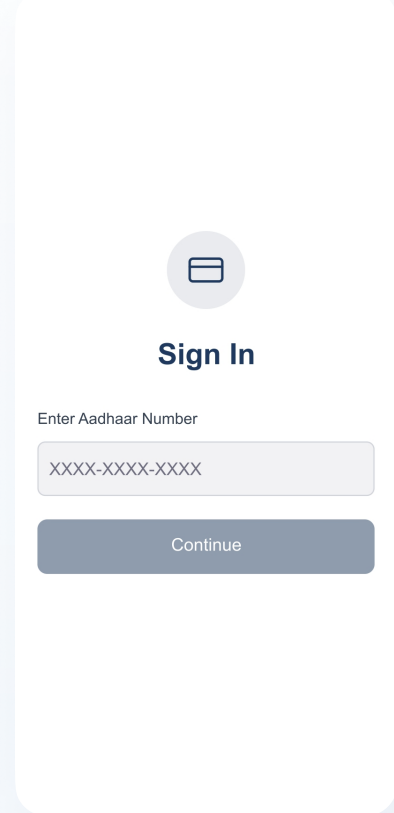
Nearby Assistance Centers


Map view
Distance Indicators
Report Changes CTA
Office
Quick Xerox Center
50m away
Sharma Stationery
80m away
Digital Print Hub
120m away
Chai Corner
150m away
Report any changes
Help others by reporting desk relocations or department shifts

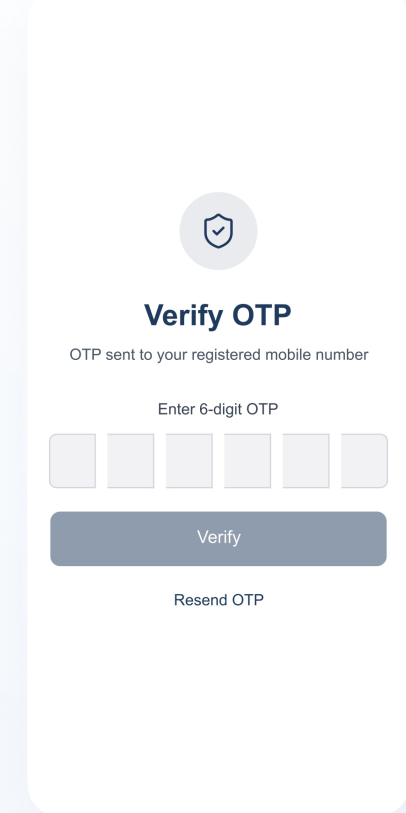
Screens


Saarthi
Clear guidance. Fewer visits.
Continue

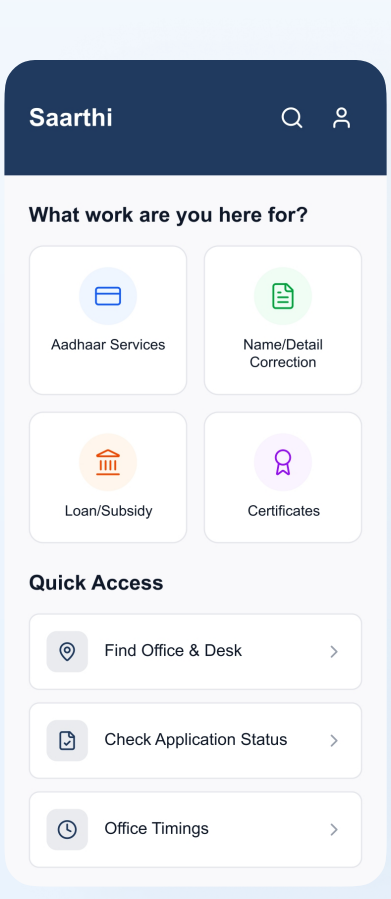
Onboarding


Sign In
Enter Aadhaar Number
XXXX-XXXX-XXXX
Continue

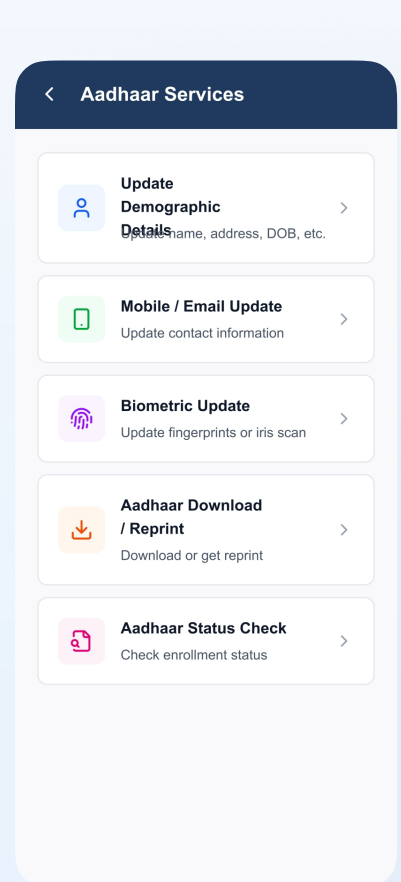
Login


Verify OTP
OTP sent to your registered mobile number
Enter 6-digit OTP
Verify
Resend OTP

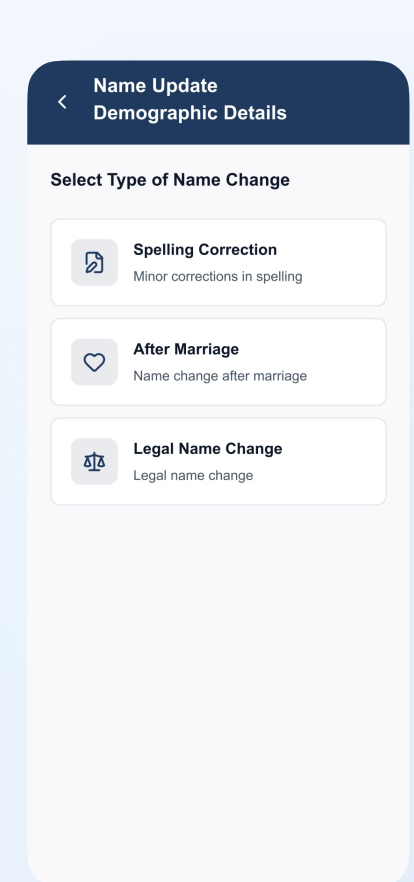
Verification


Saarthi
What work are you here for?
Aadhaar Services
Name/Detail Correction
Loan/Subsidy
Certificates
Quick Access
Find Office & Desk
Check Application Status
Office Timings

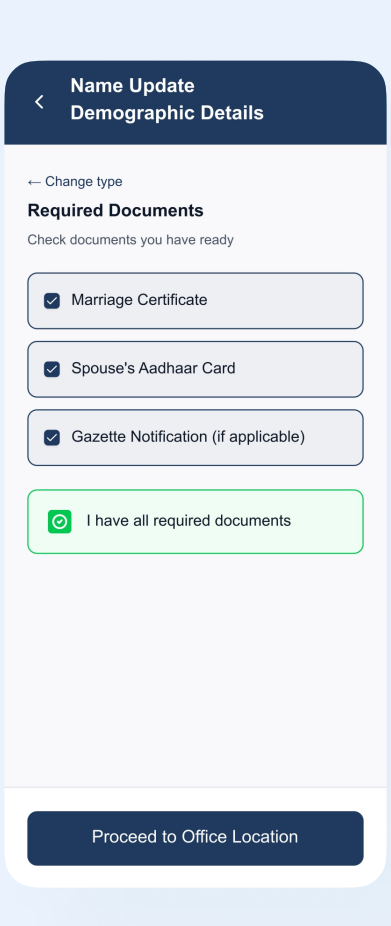
Home Dashboard


Aadhaar Services
Update Demographic Details
Update name, address, DOB, etc.
Mobile / Email Update
Update contact information
Biometric Update
Update fingerprints or iris scan
Aadhaar Download / Reprint
Download or get reprint
Aadhaar Status Check
Check enrollment status

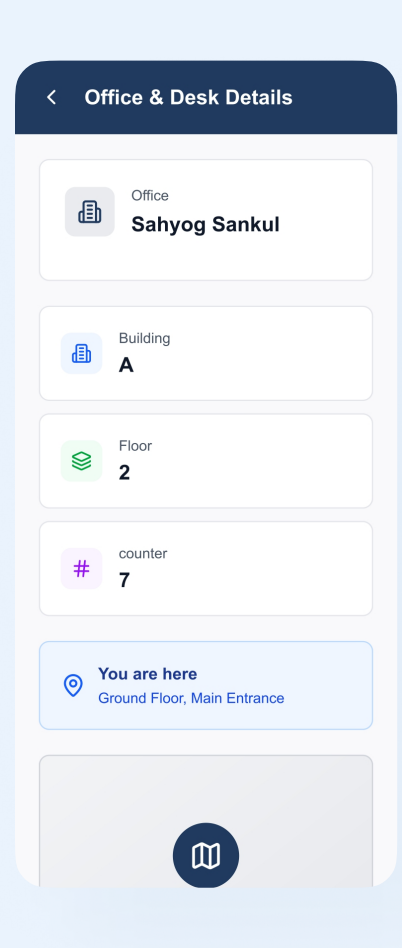
Aadhaar Service Hub


Name Update Demographic Details
Select Type of Name Change
Spelling Correction
Minor corrections in spelling
After Marriage
Name change after marriage
Legal Name Change
Legal name change

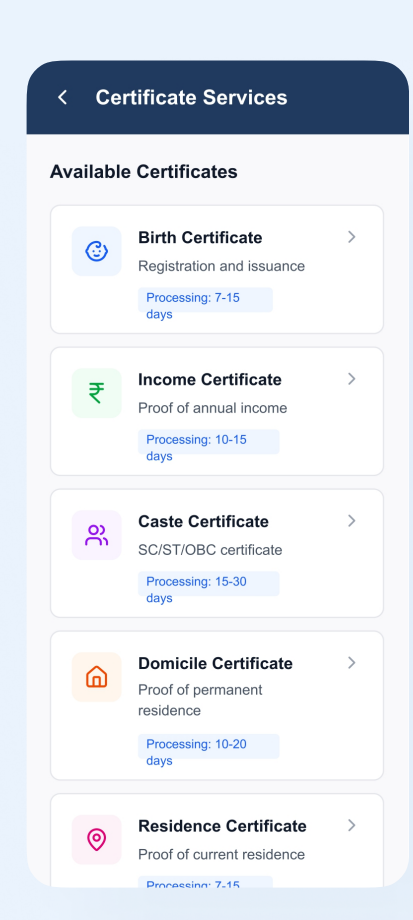
Name Update


Name Update Demographic Details
← Change type
Required Documents
Check documents you have ready
Marriage Certificate
Spouse's Aadhaar Card
Gazette Notification (if applicable)
I have all required documents
Proceed to Office Location

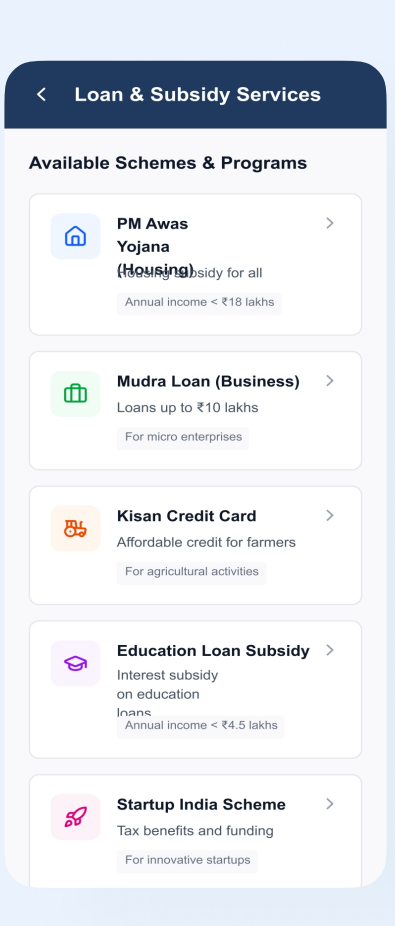
Document Checklist


Office & Desk Details
Office
Sahyog Sankul
Building
A
Floor
2
counter
7
You are here
Ground Floor, Main Entrance

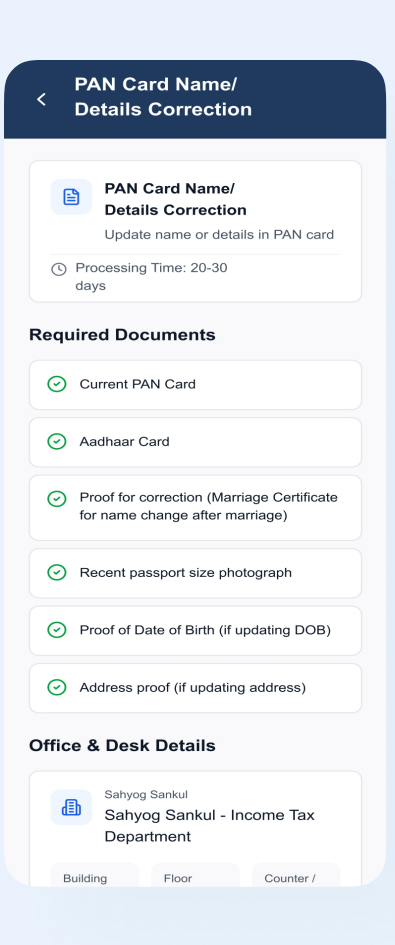
On-Site Wayfinding Screen


Certificate Services
Available Certificates
Birth Certificate
Registration and issuance
Processing: 7-15 days
Income Certificate
Proof of annual income
Processing: 10-15 days
Caste Certificate
SC/ST/OBC certificate
Processing: 15-30 days
Domicile Certificate
Proof of permanent residence
Processing: 10-20 days
Residence Certificate
Proof of current residence

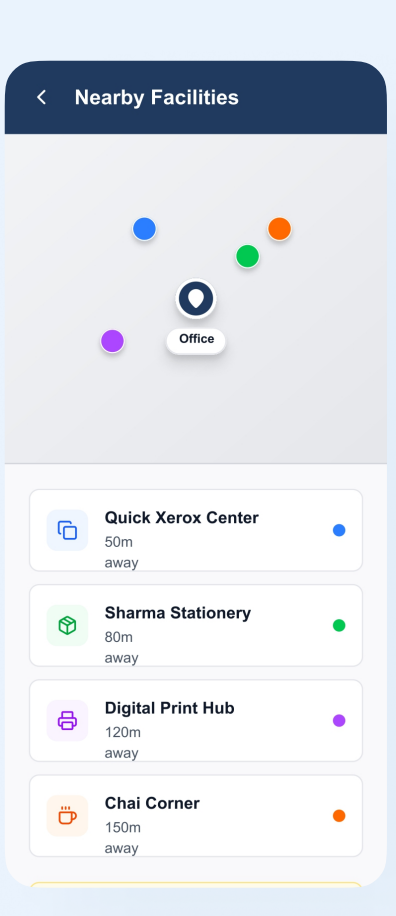
Certificate Service Directory


Loan & Subsidy Services
Available Schemes & Programs
PM Awas Yojana (Housing)
Housing subsidy for all
Annual income < ₹18 lakhs
Mudra Loan (Business)
Loans up to ₹10 lakhs
For micro enterprises
Kisan Credit Card
Affordable credit for farmers
For agricultural activities
Education Loan Subsidy
Interest subsidy on education loans
Annual income < ₹4.5 lakhs
Startup India Scheme
Tax benefits and funding
For innovative startups

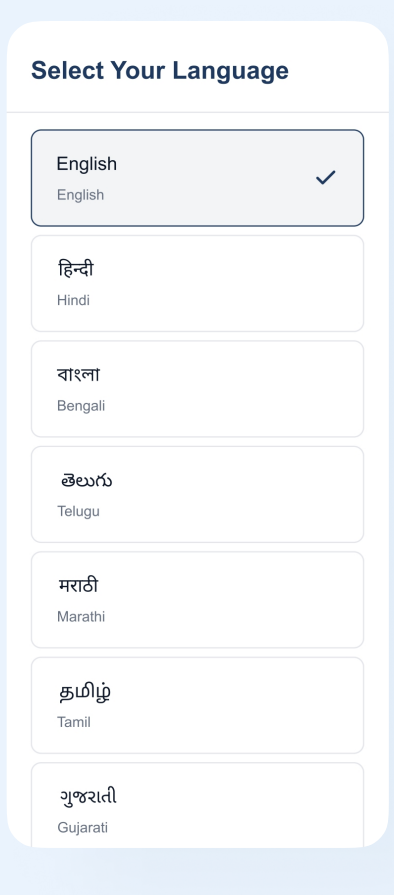
Loan & Subsidy Scheme Directory


PAN Card Name/ Details Correction
PAN Card Name/ Details Correction
Update name or details in PAN card
Processing Time: 20-30 days
Required Documents
Current PAN Card
Aadhaar Card
Proof for correction (Marriage Certificate for name change after marriage)
Recent passport size photograph
Proof of Date of Birth (if updating DOB)
Address proof (if updating address)
Office & Desk Details
Sahyog Sankul
Sahyog Sankul - Income Tax Department
Building
Floor
Counter /

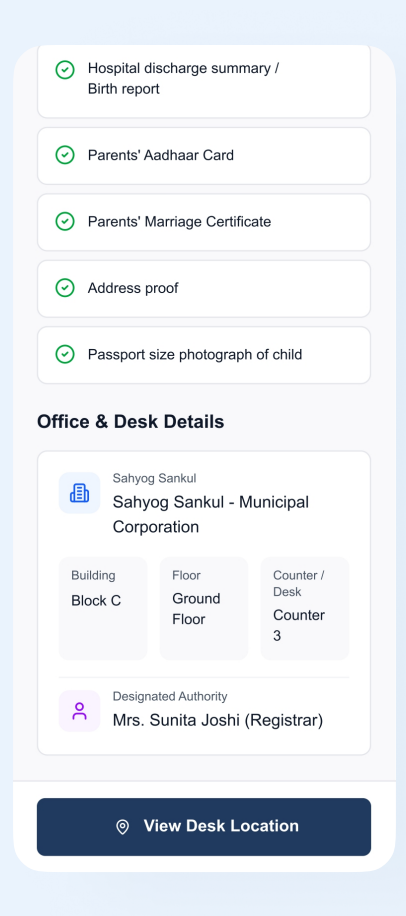
PAN Name Correction


Nearby Facilities
Office
Quick Xerox Center
50m away
Sharma Stationery
80m away
Digital Print Hub
120m away
Chai Corner
150m away

Nearby Support Facilities


Select Your Language
English
English
हिन्दी
Hindi
বাংলা
Bengali
తెలుగు
Telugu
मराठी
Marathi
தமிழ்
Tamil
ગુજરાતી
Gujarati

Language Selection


Hospital discharge summary / Birth report
Parents' Aadhaar Card
Parents' Marriage Certificate
Address proof
Passport size photograph of child
Office & Desk Details
Sahyog Sankul
Sahyog Sankul - Municipal Corporation
Building
Block C
Floor
Ground Floor
Counter / Desk
Counter 3
Designated Authority
Mrs. Sunita Joshi (Registrar)
View Desk Location

Service Requirements

[Click Here For Prototype Link]

Thank You For Watching

This case study summarizes the key findings and design outcomes. The complete research report can be accessed here

View Full Research Report →